

per cent and sugar by 9 per cent. And, surprise, the number of urban Indians eating out more than twice a week has dropped by 11 per cent. Despite the drop in daily intake of six-eight glasses of water, fruits, greens and vegetarianism, the larger picture is upbeat.

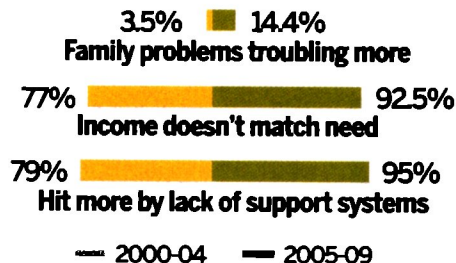
Urban Indians may eat better and get slimmer, but they are not necessarily fitter: the average male is still overweight by 3 kg and female by 7 kg; non-exercisers have gone up by 6 per cent; citizens today also lag behind in physical fitness tests for stamina, strength and flexibility.

Stress levels are down by 12 per cent in urban India. But scratch below the surface, there is more than what meets the eye: more people can't match income to needs, more report lack of support system and many more complain of rising family problems. On a heartening note, there appears to be less sickness than ever before: daily medication to hospitalisation, cholesterol to



HEMANT CHAWLA

...but in some vital areas it has zoomed up



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